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Epson ME960FWD

it to an HP authorized email address. It also has support for a lot of web apps such as *Quick Forms* which can be used to print directly off the printer without the need for a PC. The Deskjet Ink Advantage 4615 on the other hand is a little more traditional when it comes to its feature set, offering only basic Print, Scan and Copy functionality. The 4615 seems perfect for an office setting whereas the 5525 looks good for home use. This is thanks to the monochrome display and limited tweaking on the 4615, vs the many options and colour touch screen on the 5525.

When it comes to monochrome MFDs, there isn't much in terms of unique features as were seen in colour MFDs. Only the Xerox WorkCentre 3045 provides a USB slot so that content can be scanned to and

printed from a USB drive. Only the Brother 7060D provides the auto-duplex printing option, which was surprising as we were expecting most of the printers to do that. Manual duplexing is offered by the rest, where in you will have to feed the paper for the other side to be printed.

Verdict

The overall **Best Performer** award goes to the **Epson ME Office 960FWD** for its speedy prints and scans at very good quality and the feature-set offered. The only other inkjet MFD that comes close to the 960 FWD is the Brother MFC J430W. The **Best Buy** award is bagged by the **Canon Pixma E510** for its economical operation. It has the lowest cost of ownership amongst these competing MFDs.



Canon Pixma E510

Epson PictureMate PM 245

We had called for compact photo printers for this test, but only Epson was kind enough to send us one. On the outset, the Epson PM 245 looks like a picnic lunch box, thanks to its cuboidal design and the handle with which to lug it around. It comes in an all-white body having a matte finish on the sides and a glossy one on the top lid. The cartridge – T5852 is loaded from the rear side. It has a battery slot allowing you to make prints while you are on the move. The Output tray is present in the front and it houses the memory card slots – accepting SD as well as CF cards. On opening the lid you are greeted with a 2.5-inch screen with a list of buttons below it. The user interface of the PM 245 is quite intuitive and has some more tweaking options present in its Menu. On inserting a memory card you get to see the pictures on the screen in four different types of layouts. We noticed that the pictures visible on the screen appeared to be blurred initially but then became sharper after a couple of seconds. The screen is not extremely high res, so make sure you see the images on a larger screen if you are very concerned about the quality. You can even select multiple images from an SD card and then hit the print command instead of hitting print for single images. It took 61 seconds for a 4x6 inch colour print and three continuous prints took around 180 secs.



You can also connect the printer to your system which improves the speed of printing, giving colour prints in 44 seconds. The quality of the prints was top-notch. We didn't notice any unwanted artifacts and the solid areas were quite even - there was no banding. Colour reproduction was true to the original image with a slightly excess vividness which is acceptable when printing on glossy paper. Black and white images although good, are not able to resolve optimum details in the shadow areas.

This compact 4x6 printer comes for around ₹10,999 which is definitely on the higher side. The cartridge comes for ₹1,550 along with 150 sheets of glossy paper that equates to roughly ₹10 per print. For a 4x6 printer, that is quite a high a price. We would definitely recommend it for a pricing of under ₹8,000 especially if you are the kinds who want instant printouts on their vacations.

Among the monochrome laser MFDs, the **Xerox WorkCentre 3045** wins the **Best Buy** for its supreme performance and at the same time, being economical. It not only gives speedy and good quality prints, but also manages to score high on our total cost of ownership index.

The **Editor's Pick** was a tough choice between the HP DeskJet 5525 and the Brother MFC

J625W. Although the HP 5525 scores high when it comes to cost of ownership but slightly edges past in the performance scores, the Brother MFC J625W offers a lot more connectivity options. And for home use, that tilts the balance in the **Brother J625W's** favour thereby making it the **Editor's Pick**. The Canon Pixma MX517 only lost out because of its high cost of ownership. **4**